

SYMPOSIUM & PEER EXCHANGE

Intelligent Mobility

Artificial Intelligence Meets Real
Transportation

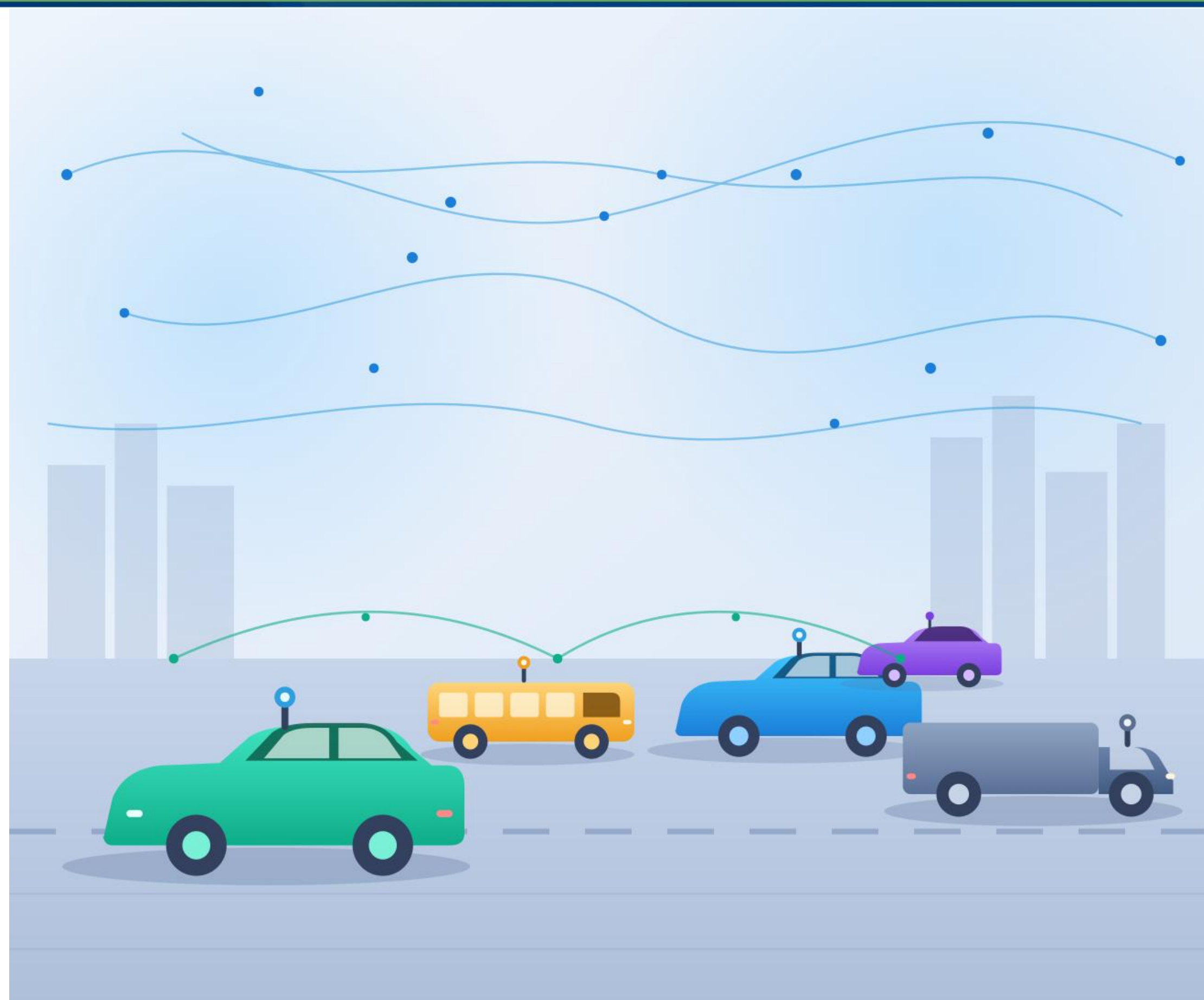
August 19 – 20, 2026

New England Institute of Technology
East Greenwich, RI

Wifi Access:
Use NEIT-Open (no password needed)



www.ridotaisymposium.org



1 DAY ONE · WEDNESDAY, AUGUST 19, 2026

Foundations, Safety, and System Performance

- 8:00 AM** Registration & Networking — Welcome Coffee & Check-in
- 8:45 AM** **Greetings & Welcoming Remarks**
- 9:00 AM** **Keynote & Fireside Chat — The Road Ahead: AI as the New Infrastructure**
- 9:45 AM** **Panel 1 — Governance Frameworks for AI Development and Deployment**
- 10:45 AM** Coffee Break
- 11:00 AM** **Technical Session 1 — AI for Proactive Road Safety**
- 12:00 PM** Lunch & Networking
- 1:15 PM** **Technical Session 2 — Optimizing ITS and Mobility Systems with AI**
- 2:15 PM** **Case Study Showcase 1 — Real-World AI Deployment**
- 3:15 PM** Break
- 3:30 PM** **Peer Roundtable 1 — Getting Started: Building an AI Strategy**
- 4:30 PM** **Key Takeaways from Day 1 and Day 2 Look Ahead**
- 5:00 PM** Exhibition & Networking Reception



2 DAY TWO · THURSDAY, AUGUST 20, 2026

Asset Management, Planning, and Future Strategy

- 8:00 AM** Registration & Networking — Welcome Coffee & Check-in
- 8:45 AM** **Greetings & Welcoming Remarks**
- 9:00 AM** **Keynote & Fireside Chat — Mobility 2040: AI's Role in Next-Gen Transport**
- 9:45 AM** **Technical Session 3 — AI in Planning and Project Development**
- 10:45 AM** Coffee Break
- 11:00 AM** **Technical Session 4 — AI in Asset Management: Predictive Maintenance and Inspection**
- 12:00 PM** Lunch & Networking — A Bridge to the Future
- 1:15 PM** **Technical Session 5 — From Data to Digital Twins**
- 2:15 PM** **Technical Session 6 — Data Analytics and Fusion: Unlocking Mobility Insights**
- 3:15 PM** Coffee Break
- 3:30 PM** **Peer Roundtable 2 — Key Take Aways**
- 4:30 PM** **Conference Wrap-Up & Closing Remarks**



DAY 1 · GREETINGS & WELCOMING REMARKS

Welcome to the RIDOT AI Symposium

Derek W. Torrey

Rhode Island Division Administrator, Federal Highway Administration

Dr. Henry Young

Assistant Provost, New England Institute of Technology (NEIT)

Robert Rocchio, P.E.

Interim Director, Rhode Island Department of Transportation



DAY 1 · KEYNOTE ADDRESS & FIRESIDE CHAT

The Road Ahead: AI as the New Infrastructure

KEYNOTE SPEAKER

Sean McMaster

Administrator, Federal Highway Administration (FHWA)

MODERATOR

Pamela Cotter

Administrator of Planning, Rhode Island Department of Transportation



KEYNOTE SPEAKER

Sean McMaster

Administrator, Federal Highway Administration (FHWA)

DAY 1 · PANEL DISCUSSION 1

Governance Frameworks for Successful AI Development and Deployment in Transportation

Scott Gausland

Chief Data & Analytics Officer, State of Rhode Island
ETSS

Jocelyn Stein

Business Integration & Digital Accessibility Manager,
Minnesota Department of Transportation

Lisa Randall

Program Manager, AI– USDOT ITS JPO with

Matt Cuddy, Operations Research Analyst, Volpe Center

Laura Chace

President & CEO, ITS America

Moderator

Lawrence Dwyer, Director, Safety and Mobility – AASHTO



Scott Gausland

Chief Data & Analytics Officer, State of Rhode Island ETSS

Jocelyn Stein

Business Integration & Digital Accessibility Manager,
Minnesota Department of Transportation

Lisa Randall & Matt Cuddy

Program Manager,
AI– USDOT ITS JPO

Operations Research Analyst,
Volpe Center

Laura Chace

President & CEO, ITS America

Coffee Break

DAY 1 · TECHNICAL SESSION 1

AI for Proactive Road Safety

Gregory Ciparelli

Chief Data Officer, Connecticut Department of
Transportation

Mac Lang

Policy Analyst, Volpe Center

Katherine Kortum, PhD, PE

Senior Program Officer, Transportation Research Board

Moderator

Lawrence Dwyer, Director, Safety and Mobility – AASHTO



Gregory Ciparelli

Chief Data Officer, Connecticut Department of Transportation

Mac Lang

Policy Analyst, Volpe Center

Katherine Kortum, PhD, PE

Senior Program Officer, Transportation Research Board

Lunch
(on your own)

DAY 1 · TECHNICAL SESSION 2

Optimizing ITS and Mobility Systems with AI

Lawrence Dwyer

Director, Safety and Mobility AASHTO

Jinhua Zhao

Professor of Cities and Transportation,
Massachusetts Institute of Technology

Donovan Guin

Director, Public Transportation - IBM

Moderator

Laura Chace, President & CEO – ITS America



Lawrence Dwyer

Director, Safety and Mobility AASHTO

Jinhua Zhao

Professor of Cities and Transportation,
Massachusetts Institute of Technology

Donovan Guin

Director, Public Transportation - IBM

DAY 1 · CASE STUDY SHOWCASE 1

Real-World AI Deployment: Lessons Learned from US and International AI Deployments

Thomas Gruenstaeudl

Group Leader, Planning Department; Project Manager for Special Projects ASFINAG BMG (Austria)

Jennifer Volkening

Director of Data Analytics and Governance, Utah DOT

Jinhua Zhao

Professor of Cities and Transportation, Massachusetts Institute of Technology

Moderator

Patricia Hendren, Executive Director – The Eastern Transportation Coalition



Thomas Gruenstaedl

Group Leader, Planning Department
Project Manager for Special Projects
ASFINAG BMG (Austria)

Jennifer Volkening

Director of Data Analytics and Governance, Utah DOT

Jinhua Zhao

Professor of Cities and Transportation
Massachusetts Institute of Technology

Coffee Break

DAY 1 · PEER ROUNDTABLE 1

Getting Started: Building an AI Strategy

Alexander Walcher

Managing Director, ASFINAG BMG (Austria) Vice
President, PIARC

Giri Venkateela

Innovation Officer, New Jersey DOT

Robert Sheehan, P.E.

AI Deployment Center of Excellence, Federal Highway
Administration

Mike Snodgrass

AI Specialist, Google

Moderator

Craig Thor, Chief Scientist, Turner-Fairbank Highway Research Center – FHWA



Alexander Walcher

Managing Director, ASFINAG BMG (Austria)
Vice President, PIARC

Giri Venkiteela

Innovation Officer, New Jersey DOT

Robert Sheehan, P.E.

AI Deployment Center of Excellence, Federal Highway Administration

Mike Snodgrass

AI Specialist, Google

DAY 1 · CLOSING

Key Takeaways from Day 1 and Day 2 Look Ahead

Hyun-A Park

President Spy Pond Partners

Pamela Cotter

Rhode Island Department of Transportation



Exhibition and Networking Reception (Sponsored by ESRI)

2 DAY TWO · THURSDAY, AUGUST 20, 2026

Asset Management, Planning, and Future Strategy

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DAY 2 · TECHNICAL SESSION 5

From Data to Digital Twins: The Future of Asset Management

Charles Major

Manager of GIS Data Engineering
Massachusetts Department of Transportation

Giri Venkiteela

Innovation Officer, New Jersey DOT

Grace Sammartino

Senior Account Executive, ESRI

Moderator

Robert Sheehan, P.E., AI Deployment Center of Excellence – FHWA



Charles Major

Manager of GIS Data Engineering
Massachusetts Department of Transportation

Giri Venkiteela

Innovation Officer, New Jersey DOT

Grace Sammartino

Senior Account Executive, ESRI

DAY 2 · TECHNICAL SESSION 6

Data Analytics and Fusion: Unlocking Mobility Insights

Jennifer Volkening

Director of Data Analytics and Governance, Utah DOT

Justin O'Daniel

Data & AI Specialist, Databricks

Justin Bruner, P.E., MBA

Asset Management Engineer, Pennsylvania Department of
Transportation

Moderator

Timothy Henry, Interim Director, AI RI Hub; Professor – Rhode Island College



Jennifer Volkening

Director of Data Analytics and Governance
Utah DOT

Justin O'Daniel

Data & AI Specialist, Databricks

Justin Bruner, P.E., MBA

Asset Management Engineer
Pennsylvania Department of Transportation

Coffee Break

(Sponsored by IBM)

DAY 2 · PEER ROUNDTABLE 2

Key Takeaways

Matt Cuddy

Operations Research Analyst, Volpe Center

Katherine Kortum, PhD, PE

Senior Program Officer, Transportation Research Board

Gregory Ciparelli

Chief Data Officer, Connecticut Department of Transportation

Moderator

Hyun-A Park, President, Spy Pond Partners, LLC

Lawrence Dwyer

Director, Safety and Mobility, AASHTO

Jocelyn Stein

Business Integration & Digital Accessibility Manager,,
Minnesota Department of Transportation



DAY 2 · CONFERENCE WRAP-UP & CLOSING NOTE

Conference Wrap-Up & Closing Note

Pamela Cotter

Rhode Island Department of Transportation

